

Minutes of WCDT AGM 16th July 2026

Directors

Philip Ross – Chairperson

Ann Warren

Nicole Jones – Secretary/Treasurer

Lynda Grant

Apologies given for absence by Gary Sinclair

Andrew McParland

Financial Reporting Review Nov 2024 - Oct 2025

All Directors had given a copy of the Financial Reports as submitted to Companies House and OSCR to review in preparation of the meeting, plus it has been posted on the Village website and Facebook page for public view.

Thanks again to Donald Smith in the oversight role and formally signing off of our relevant financial documents as required to be submitted to the Scottish Charity governing body, OSCR.

Fundraising - The Trust held a successful Christmas Draw to raise funds of £950 to pay fixed costs e.g. Insurance and website. The agreed share of £250 – minus 50% of associated costs has been paid to the Village Hall funds as a donation.

Village Garden Project - received its full instalment of funds raised by the community via the Co-op and the new Village Garden area has been largely completed, with only minor ongoing works required to keep the area tidy.

Woodland - Zurich continues to be our **insurance provider** and has maintained the same £330 annual fee. We were chosen as Scotland's Finest Small Community Woodland Award Winner for 2024 which had a prize of £1000 and a presentation at Holyrood. We also received a grant £3940 from SSEN as part of their "SSEN Transmission East Coast Fund" and this will be used to improve/update our entrance signage and seating.

Defibrillator has raised £312, enough to cover 2026 costs of Community Heartbeat Trust annual fee of £162 and will need to fundraise to cover 2026 costs onwards. We have agreed that £100 will be set aside annually from the Christmas Draw funds in 2026 onwards to help cover this cost. The unit itself is continued to be checked weekly to ensure in full working order and replacement parts ordered as needed.

Generator/Resilience Centre – The new generator has been in place, ready to provide electricity to the Village Hall in a power cut to allow the Hall to be used as a Resilience

Centre for our villagers to re-charge devices, fill hot water bottles and have a hot drink and warm up in a heated space. The generator is tested monthly to ensure in full working order, ready for use in an emergency.

Woodland Land Lease Issue – We continue to be unable to secure another 20 yr lease for the Woodland land from Lindertis Estate and are blocked from applying for a wide range of grants due to be only a rolling 1 year lease. We continue to contact the estate owners regarding trying to resolve this.

Website – the install of a new website for the Village is work in progress and changes will be seen on the new site over the coming year, to a more accessible, modern & user-friendly format. We have 2 **new advertisers** on the website – Angus Scaffolding and Westmuir Electrical and thank them for their continued support of the community.

Village Hall Refurbishment – Grants have been secured from National Lottery and Community Council to renovate the exterior of the Hall and improve energy efficiency through upgrading the windows and insulation. Works have been completed successfully to allow the Hall to host community activities for years to come.

Directors - Philip Ross, Andrew McParland & Gary Sinclair were happy to put themselves forward for re-election.

They were duly proposed, seconded, and approved by the 3 remaining directors (Nicola Jones, Lynda Grant, and Ann Warren) to stand for another 2 years.

We also concluded that the AGM would be best held much earlier in the year, as the timescales of financial year end of October 31st and report submission deadlines suit a more timely schedule.

As per agreement made by unanimous vote in AGM 2023, we have now set up a process for a **Rotating Chair**, with a list of responsibilities/Routines so that the same procedures and processes are followed & carried out consistently every year regardless of who holds the office of Chair for that year.

We agreed to continue with the process of a rotating chair.

Rotation to be determined alphabetically as follows: -

Andrew McParland, Philip Ross, Gary Sinclair, Ann Warren, and round to Lynda Grant again and so on.

Due to unforeseen circumstances, Gary Sinclair will not be able to take his turn this year – Ann Warren will be Chair for the financial year of 2025 -2026

